
How do we learn

To effectively stimulate the learning process, you must make conscious choices between various possible learning activities in the transdisciplinary process. Different activities can be employed to maximize each phase of the project, from initial acquaintance to the dissemination of results. This page provides practical tips and tools for the creation of a successful educational project.

Ensuring effective learning in transdisciplinary education

How do you ensure that what you aim to learn in transdisciplinary education is truly learned? There are different phases in a transdisciplinary project where various activities can be implemented to facilitate learning for all team members.

In **the first phase**, you learn about the problem to determine the project's questions and objectives. Dialogues among team members is crucial for achieving this:

- Immerse yourself in the problem context: attend events and have informal conversations with the community to gain a deep understanding of the issue.
- Visualize the problem: create mind maps, view images, and use soft systems methodology to map out the problem visually.
- Engage in dialogues: encourage discussions among team members to understand different viewpoints. The 'Three Types of Knowledge' tool can be useful here.

During the **project execution phase**, you integrate the knowledge, experiences, and ideas of all team members. This can involve working towards joint products such as prototypes or events. Techniques like brainstorming, group reflections, and presentations are helpful here.

Coordination with Stakeholders

Throughout the project execution, ensure alignment with the research stakeholders. This includes periodic reporting and inviting stakeholders for guest lectures or feedback sessions.

In the **final phase**, you share and disseminate the project results and seek opportunities for a new transdisciplinary educational cycle. This can be achieved by presenting at external locations, writing project reports or sustainability plans, and initiating new collaborations.

In addition to the phase-specific activities, two types of activities occur throughout the entire project:

- **Reflection on the process, project, and team:** reflection exercises and peer feedback can enhance the reflective and learning attitude of all team members.
- **Process focus:** see the project as an iterative process, moving back and forth through different project phases. Often, the process itself is of a more central focus than the outcome. Activities like mapping assignments, dialogues, and visualizations can support this focus.

In transdisciplinary education, everyone learns. Therefore, the above activities are valuable for all participants. It is important to actively involve students as equal participants in all phases of the process, as they can learn significantly from these phases, and their input is crucial for the project's success.

Tool: For learning activities related to inner development goals, you can find potential inspiration in the [Transition Maker Toolbox of the EWUU alliance](#).